

Employee Benefits Overview

Northwind Systems GmbH

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1. About This Document

This overview summarises the benefits available to employees of Northwind Systems in addition to salary. It is a summary only. The governing terms are those of each provider's scheme documentation, which People Operations will supply on request.

Paid leave entitlement is not covered here. Annual leave, sickness absence, parental leave and every other category of paid and unpaid absence are set out in the annual leave and absence policy, which is the sole authority on entitlement, accrual and carry-over.

Benefits are available to permanent employees from their start date unless a qualifying period is stated below. Fixed-term staff on contracts of twelve months or more receive the same benefits. Contractors are not eligible.

2. Pension

Northwind operates a defined contribution scheme. The company contributes 6 percent of gross salary. Where the employee contributes from their own salary, the company matches that contribution up to a further 3 percent, giving a maximum combined contribution of 15 percent.

Enrolment is automatic from the start date, with the employee contribution defaulted to 3 percent. The rate can be changed at any time in the benefits portal, and opting out entirely is possible but forfeits the matched element.

Contributions are made through salary sacrifice where local tax rules allow.

3. Health

Private medical cover

Employees and their registered dependants are covered from the start date. The scheme includes outpatient consultation, diagnostics, inpatient treatment and mental health support, with no exclusion for conditions existing before the start date.

Dependants are added in the benefits portal within thirty days of the start date, or within thirty days of a qualifying life event such as marriage or the birth of a child.

Preventive care

An annual health check is available to every employee at company cost, booked directly with the provider through the benefits portal. Seasonal vaccination is offered on site each autumn.

Employee assistance programme

A confidential support line is available twenty-four hours a day to employees and to members of their household, covering counselling, legal information and financial guidance. Use of the service is not visible to Northwind in any form.

4. Insurance

- **Life assurance** -- Four times annual salary, payable to nominated beneficiaries. Nominations are recorded in the benefits portal and should be reviewed after any change in personal circumstances.
- **Income protection** -- 70 percent of salary after a twenty-six week deferral period, payable until recovery or retirement age.
- **Business travel insurance** -- A group policy covers all employees travelling on approved business. Individually purchased travel insurance is not reimbursable.
- **Accident insurance** -- Statutory cover applies in addition, through the relevant national scheme.

5. Wellbeing and Activity

- A monthly wellbeing allowance of EUR 40, claimable against gym membership, sports club fees, classes or equipment, through the expense tool under "wellbeing".
- Company-subsidised bicycle leasing, with the cost taken from gross salary where local tax rules allow.
- Showers and covered bicycle storage at the Munich and Krakow sites.
- Sports groups organised by employees, with room and equipment support from Facilities Management.

6. Family

- Childcare allowance of EUR 150 per month per child under six, claimable against a registered provider's invoice.
- Enhanced parental pay above the statutory minimum, as set out in the annual leave and absence policy.
- A one-off payment of EUR 500 on the birth or adoption of a child.
- Access to the employee assistance programme for all household members.

7. Financial

- Salary paid on the twenty-fifth of each month, or the preceding business day where that falls on a weekend or public holiday.
- Company bonus scheme, determined at company level and paid in March. Eligibility requires employment on the payment date.
- Long service awards at five, ten and fifteen years.
- Referral bonus of EUR 2000 for a successful hire, paid after the referred employee completes probation.

8. Working Environment

- Home workstation allowance of EUR 250 per year, as described in the flexible and distributed working policy.
- Subsidised canteen at the Munich site.
- Free coffee, tea and filtered water at all sites.
- Annual development budget, as described in the learning and development policy.

9. Public Transport

A monthly public transport subsidy of EUR 50 is available at all sites, claimed against a season ticket or pass through the expense tool. Individual journey tickets are not claimable under this benefit; commuting costs are otherwise a private expense.

10. Changing Your Benefits

Most elections can be changed at any time in the benefits portal. Where a provider imposes an annual enrolment window, it runs during November for the following calendar year, and People Operations communicates the dates in October.

A qualifying life event -- marriage, registered partnership, birth, adoption, or a change in a dependant's circumstances -- allows changes outside the normal window, provided they are made within thirty days of the event.

11. Leaving the Company

Cover under the medical, life assurance and income protection schemes ends on the last day of employment. Pension contributions cease with the final salary payment; the accumulated fund remains the employee's and the provider will set out the options.

Continuation of medical cover on an individual basis is offered by the provider at the employee's own cost, and must be arranged within thirty days of leaving.

12. Questions

Benefits questions go to People Operations. Payroll questions go to Finance Operations. Questions about the benefits portal itself go to the IT service desk.

13. Related Documents

- Annual leave and absence policy
- Flexible and distributed working policy
- Learning and development policy
- Business travel and expense reimbursement policy